MILITARY SPECIFICATION

GLOVES, SURGEONS'

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers natural latex rubber gloves suitable for surgical procedures. The gloves shall be medium weight and shall be supplied in the non-sterile condition.

1.2 Classification. Surgeons' gloves covered by this specification shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.2).

Size 6
Size 6-1/2
Size 7
Size 7-1/2
Size 8
Size 8-1/2

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

- Federal

PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Setup.

Military

MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap: Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

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STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-601	Rubber, Sampling and Testing.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION

Pharmacopeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pa. 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Gloves shall be fabricated of natural rubber latex of the highest quality. The dusting powder shall be in accordance with the requirements for Absorbable Dusting Powder, U.S.P.

3.2 Design and construction.

3.2.1 Edge of cuff. The edge of the cuff shall be rolled outward and backward to form a self-binding roll, or left flat, or reinforced along the edge with a band, or shall be a combination of both roll and band.

3.2.2 Fingers. The gloves shall be four fingers and opposed thumb style made on standard commercial surgical glove forms. A pair of gloves shall consist of one right-hand glove and one left-hand glove. The base of the thumb on the palm side shall be continued to the glove palm in such a manner that the thumb-crotch area shall show no noticeable creases.

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3.3 Finish. Finish of the gloves shall be smooth,

3.4 Sizes. Gloves procured under this specification shall be of the sizes listed in Table I, and as specified in the invitation for bids (6.4). Shall be furnished in size indicated for appropriate stock number and item identification (see 1.2).

Table I. Length and Palm Circumference

Size (Circumference of palm in inches) 1	Length, inches, minimum
6	10
6-1/2	10
7	10
7-1/2	10-1/2
8	10-1/2
8-1/2	10-1/2

1 A tolerance of -1/8 or + 1/4 inch in circumference will be permitted.

3.5 Dimensions. Length shall be as specified in Table I. Circumference at the palm shall be as specified in Table I, when measured in accordance with 4.4. Thickness shall be as specified in Table II, when tested in accordance with 4.4, except that the thickness at any place on the glove shall be no less than 0.004 inch. Visible thin spots (4.4) shall be measured.

Table II. Thickness in Inches

Finger Tip		Palm		Crotch		Wrist	
Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
0.008	0.015	0.008	0.013	0.007	0.013	0.006	0.013

3.6 Marking. Gloves shall be stamped with the manufacturer's name or trademark and glove size. Marking shall remain legible when sterilized in accordance with 4.4.2

3.7 Color. Gloves shall be natural or brown.

3.8 Color Coding. When specified in the invitation for bids (6.4), the gloves shall be color coded as follows, 6-1/2 shall be blue; 7 shall be red; 7-1/2 shall be black; 8 shall be green; all others shall be color coded yellow. The color coding shall be an integral part of the glove, and shall remain legible when sterilized in accordance with 4.4.2. The color coding shall be either the flat band described in 3.2.1, or shall be a separate band, or color coded size numbers.

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3.9 Dusting powder. Each pair of gloves shall be dusted with absorbable dusting powder conforming to the requirements of the United States Pharmacopeia. A minimum amount of dusting powder is desired.

3.10 Mechanical properties. Mechanical properties shall be as expressed in Table III, when tested in conformance with 4.4, 4.4.1, 4.4.2, and Table VI.

TABLE III. Mechanical Properties

Column 1 Unaged Unsterilized Specimens			Column 2 Aged Specimens		Column 3 Sterilized Specimens		
Modulus (Tensile Stress) at 500 percent Elongation (Max.) (lb per sq. in)	Tensile Strength (Min.) (lb per sq. in.)	Ultimate Elongation (Min.) Percent	Duration of aging (hours)	Tensile Strength (Min.) (lb. per sq. in.)	Ultimate Elongation (Min.) percent	No. of Sterilizations	Tensile Strength (Min.) (lb per sq. in.)
						5	4000
800	4000	800	96	3000	800	10	3500

3.11 Accelerated aging. Accelerated aging shall produce a tensile strength no lower than indicated in Table III and shall be performed in accordance with the method described in 4.4.1.

3.12 Sterilization. Sterilization shall produce physicals no lower than indicated in Table III and shall be performed in accordance with the method described in 4.4.2.

3.13 Caution notice. The wrapper to each pair of gloves shall be imprinted as follows with letters 1/8 inch or larger in height: "Caution: After donning, remove powder by wiping gloves thoroughly with a sterile wet sponge, sterile wet towel, or other effective method."

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the gloves, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the FSN, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be as indicated in Table IV. The unit for examination shall be a glove, but selection shall be by pairs to insure examination of both right-hand and left-hand gloves. Defects shall be as listed in Table V.

Table IV. Sampling for Examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major	I	1.0
Minor	I	4.0

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table VI. The unit for testing shall be a pair of gloves. Where possible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Failure of any sample or specimen to comply with any test requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

4.3 Examination. The gloves shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the following classification of defects. Examination shall include but shall not be limited to the defects listed in Table V.

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Table V. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Pinholes.
102	Presence of particles embedded in glove.
103	Tears and large holes.
104	Defects in design.
105	Sizes not as specified.
106	Presence of blisters.
107	Visible thin spots.
108	Tackiness.
Minor	
201	Presence of foreign material, loose particles.
202	Presence of small clusters of blisters.
203	Marking (incomplete, missing, illegible, incorrect, not legible after sterilization.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted in accordance with Federal Test Method Standard No. 601. The test methods shall be as listed in Table VI. Measurements of thickness shall include visible thin spots and places listed in Table II, and all four fingers and thumb. All physical tests and measurements shall be made prior to inflation and visual examination (i.e. physical tests to be made on gloves other than those subjected to visual examination). Particular care shall be exercised to be sure that the dumbbell piece for testing tensile and elongation is completely free of nicks and rough spots. The die for cutting these pieces shall, therefore, be free of nicks and be very sharp, and the cut made on a fresh spot in the cutting board on each piece. When the glove is inflated for visual examination, inflation shall be limited to 350 percent (plus or minus 50 percent) elongation on any part of the glove. When conducting the oxygen bomb tests, the pieces shall be tested in the vessel separately, and with no other item present, in order to avoid contamination of this very light rubber film. Test specimens for tensile strength determination shall be 1/4 inch wide over a gage length of one inch.

4.4.1 Accelerated aging. Samples and specimens shall be protected against exposure to strong light prior to aging by storing in lightproof containers, except while being inspected, prepared, or measured. Specimens shall be aged in accordance with Test Method 7111 of Fed. Test Method Std. 601, except that duration of aging shall be as specified in Table III.

4.4.2 Sterilization. Sample shall be protected against exposure to strong light prior to sterilization by placing them in lightproof containers, except while being inspected or prepared. Samples shall be sterilized in accordance with Test Method 7411 of Fed. Test Method Std. 601, except the units for

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sterilization may be gloves or dumbbell strips. Limitations of air per 1000 volumes of steam shall not apply, rather the air shall be flushed from the sterilizer between sterilizations. At the end of sterilizations the units shall be removed and tested in accordance with the requirements in Table III.

Table VI. Sampling for Tests

Characteristic	Requirement	Test * procedure	Inspection level	AQL(percent defective)
Tensile stress	3.10 & Table III	4.4, 4131	S-3	1.5
Tensile strength	3.10 & Table III	4.4, 4111	S-3	1.5
Ultimate elongation	3.10 & Table III	4.4, 4121	S-3	1.5
Accelerated aging	3.11	4.4.1, 7111	S-2	2.5
Sterilization	3.12	4.4.2, 7411	S-2	2.5
Dimensions	3.4, 3.5	4.4, 2011, 2331 & 2411	S-2	2.5

* Four digit numbers refer to Test Methods indicated in Test Method 601.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One pair of gloves, of the size specified constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table VII shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table VII. Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	12 units	432 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

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5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Unit package. The gloves shall be supplied in a folded wrapper. The gloves shall be placed flat, prior to folding the wrapper over the gloves, without rolling or folding, except that the wrist portion shall be folded inside out over the palm. The wrapper shall be of sufficient size to permit flat placement of the gloves and shall completely cover and separate both gloves. The gloves shall be packaged in such a manner as to permit ready identification of the left and right hand gloves and to permit ready dispensing. The gloves may be further packaged in a heat-sealed, peel-open type envelope of appropriate size suitable for sterilization.

5.1.3.2 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except commercial colors will be acceptable, or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening under normal handling.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Fiberboard boxes shall conform to special requirements specified PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.3 Closure. Closure of wood boxes shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification. Closure of each fiberboard box shall be as specified in the appendix, and waterproofing shall conform with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.4 Strapping. Strapping, when required, shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification.

NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

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5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure of wood boxes shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II of PPP-B-636. In addition, fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. In addition to any commerical marking, each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES.

6.1 The surgeons' gloves covered by this specification are intended for usage in surgery where the greatest mechanical strength is required.

6.2 This specification covers the following items listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

Stock No. •	Item Identification
6515-339-7800	GLOVES, SURGEONS', Size 6
6515-339-7820	GLOVES, SURGEONS', Size 6-1/2
6515-339-7840	GLOVES, SURGEONS', Size 7
6515-339-7860	GLOVES, SURGEONS', Size 7-1/2
6515-339-7880	GLOVES, SURGEONS', Size 8
6515-339-7900	GLOVES, SURGEONS', Size 8-1/2

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6.3 This specification is intended to cover the types of surgeons gloves normally procured to meet military requirements. It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title, nor all types and sizes which are commercially available.

6.4 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size (see 1.2 and 3.4).
(c) Color coding (see 3.8).
(d) Level of packaging, packing, and marking required.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1664

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5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

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